

ENG524 Mid-Term Subjective by Barbie

1. What is Discourse Analysis?

The term *Discourse Analysis* was first introduced by Zelling Harris (1952) to examine: the language beyond the level of the sentence, relation between linguistic and non-linguistic behaviour. It looks at patterns of language across texts as well as the social and cultural contexts the texts occur.

2. Write Assumptions of Discourse Analysis.

Four main assumptions:

- a. Language is ambiguous* - What things mean is never absolutely clear. All communication involves interpreting what other people mean.
- b. Language is always 'in the world'* - what language means is always a matter of where and when it is used and what it is used to do.
- c. The way we use language is inseparable* from who we are and the different social groups to which we belong. We use language to display different kinds of social identities.
- d. Language is never used all by itself.* It is always combined with other things such as our tone of voice, facial expressions and gestures when we speak, and the fonts, layout and graphics we use in written texts.

3. Write Three aspects of Genre.

Three important aspects of genres:

- a. Genres are communicative events
- b. Conventions and Constraints
- c. Creativity

4. Who are the Key Scholars of CDA?

- ❖ Norman Fairclough
- ❖ Ruth Wodak
- ❖ Teun A. van Dijk

5. Write three Approaches of CDA

- ❖ **Socio-cultural Approach** (Fairclough – key proponent)
- ❖ **Socio-Cognitive Approach** (Van Dijk – key component who concentrates on social cognition as the mediating part between text and society.)
- ❖ **Discourse-Historical Approach** (Ruth Wodak views discourse as a form of social practice.)

6. Framework for text-Analysis.

Fairclough provides a three-dimensional framework for the analysis of text and discourse:

- (a) the linguistic description of the formal properties of the text;
- (b) the interpretation of the relationship between the discursive processes/interaction and the text.
- (c) the explanation of the relationship between discourse and social and cultural reality.

7. Main Tenets of CDA (Important For True False Section)

Fairclough and Wodak (1997: 271-80) summarize the main tenets of CDA as follows:

- CDA addresses social problems
- Power relations are discursive
- Discourse constitutes society and culture

- Discourse does ideological work
- Discourse is historical
- The link between text and society is mediated
- Discourse analysis is interpretative and explanatory
- Discourse is a form of social action.
- Critical discourse analysts take explicit position, and thus want to understand, expose, and ultimately resist social inequality.
- CDA has a purpose, clear-cut and strong message/ Socially Critical and analytical.

8. What are General Principles of CCDA?

CCDA focuses on the cultural aspects of any given 'text': verbal and non-verbal alike. This approach is guided by the following principles:

- ❖ No text is independent of its cultural contexts.
- ❖ CCDA employs tools and methodologies taken from the discipline of Cultural Studies, such as the heuristic of decoding cultural codes.
- ❖ Cross-cultural or multi-cultural perspectives facilitate the identification of unique elements of specific cultural codes and thus contribute to the process of decoding them.
- ❖ CCDA analyses verbal and non-verbal practices (e.g., visual practices as well as cultural sites) alike, because it does not focus on the study of linguistic structures as such.
- ❖ CCDA seeks to expose the 'global dictionary' of power and manipulation.
- ❖ CCDA demonstrates that as far as the rhetoric of power is concerned, there is no difference between small and large cultural communities. (MCQs)

9. Write the Strategies of Normalization.

- a) Euphemization – aims to color the social object in positive tones, in terms of its appearance, character, or valuation;
- b) Naturalization – aims to represent the social object as a force or event independent of human agency, or as an inevitable outcome of the laws of nature;
- c) Justification – aims to depict the social object as just, rational, worthy of support.

10. Strategies of Impersonalization (Important for Fill in the Blanks section).

An explanation of the relevant social object (e.g., peace) which removes the human factor and focuses on abstract organizational structures (i.e., movements, states). The penetration of the great powers to the vacuum created in the new states in Asia and Africa (Inbar 2000: 172). The escalation of the tensions between Jewish and Arab people in the 1920s and 1930s (Avieli-Tabibian 2009: 41). New centers of power began to rise around the world (Inbar 2000: 176). At the end of the 1920s, a new wave of violent acts against Jewish people erupted (Avieli-Tabibian 2009: 43). All this increased the friction between Jewish and Arab people (Avieli-Tabibian 2009: 43). The leaders of the Arab nations used the hatred towards Israel as a way to consolidate their people (Naveh 1999: 158). A related discursive strategy is that of personifying the state by using body metaphors (Musolff 2004, 2010). For example: Europe was embroiled in a net of treaties and agreements which tied its hands and every small spark could have ignited the fire of war (Inbar 2004: 82). In the sixties security problems on [Israel's] eastern and northern borders intensified (Avieli-Tabibian 2009: 180).

11. Write down the Characteristics or Dimensions of DHA.

The DHA is three-dimensional:

- (1) Specific contents or topics of a specific discourse are identified;
- (2) discursive strategies are investigated;
- (3) linguistic means are examined as types, and the specific, context-dependent linguistic realizations are examined as tokens.

12. What are Three forms of critique in the DHA? (Write just Names in 3marks question)

❖ The text or discourse immanent critique:

Text or discourse immanent critique is primarily knowledge-related. It assesses conflicts, contradictions and inconsistencies in the text. e.g. with respect to cohesion, presuppositions, argumentation and turn-taking structures. This form of critique relies on rhetorical, text-linguistic, pragmatic, politico-linguistic and argumentation theoretical norms.

❖ The socio-diagnostic critique

Socio-diagnostic critique is both epistemic and deontic. It aims at exposing manipulation in and by discourse, at revealing ethically problematic aspects of discursive practices. It focusses on discrepancies between discursive and other social practices and functions as a form of social control. It relies on social, historical and political background knowledge.

❖ The prospective critique

Prospective critique is strongly application-oriented. It is practical, aimed at reducing dysfunctional communication and language barriers, at improving communication within public institutions by elaborating proposals and guidelines on the basis of careful fieldwork.

13. What are Discursive Strategies?

Discursive strategies may be included:

- ❖ Nomination
- ❖ Predication
- ❖ Argumentation
- ❖ Perspectivisation
- ❖ Mitigation and Intensification

14. Technologization:

Fairclough mentions **macro domain** of discourse, i.e. political talk, government policies while, keeps discourse at place work in **micro-domain**. He has used a term “**technologization of discourse**” as top-down intervention to change discursive within orders of discourse, i.e. from politics (macro) to ‘work place (micro)’. Fairclough has argued that the link between sociocultural practice and the other two dimensions involves the integration of 'macro' and 'micro' analysis of discursive events, where the former includes analysis of discourse **technologization** processes.

15. Define Context.

Context is dynamic, changing as the discourse progresses. Blommaert (2005: 251) **defines** context as “the totality of conditions under which discourse is being produced, circulated and interpreted”. Van Dijk (2005: 237) **defines** context as “the cognitive, social, political, cultural and historical environments of discourse” (original emphasis).

16. Define Identity.

Identity is the image one has of oneself or is held by others and which can apply to individuals or to groups, although not usually mentioned as a feature of context, is also an important contextual factor, because the image one has of oneself or of others will affect one’s interpretation of their actions and motivations (Flowerdew, 2018).

17. Write the speaking mnemonics proposed by Hymes. (You can pick any Five)

Following are the speaking mnemonics proposed by Hymes:

Setting: Physical or abstract setting (e.g. office service)

Participants: Speaker, hearer, overhearer

Ends: purpose, goals and outcomes.

Act Sequence: form the event taken place, ordering of speech acts, etc.

Key: Tone, manner, spirit of the speech acts.

Instrumentalities: Channel or mode (e.g., telephone, spoken or written)

Norms: Norms of interaction and interpretation.

Genre: Type of speech event (e.g. story, joke, lecture).

18. Write 3-4 points on Conversation Analysis (CA).

- ❖ CA views context as constructed moment by moment through conversational moves (Bhatia, Jones and Flowerdew 2008: 16).
- ❖ There are in fact two views here: a strong view and a weak view.
- ❖ **Strong view** of Schegloff (e.g. 1987) emphasizes that the evidence of context needs to be located in the sequence of speaker turns.

- ❖ The **weaker view** argues for going outside the immediate interactional context to the institutional context to arrive at a more grounded analysis (e.g. Drew and Heritage, 1993).
- ❖ **CA** allows critical discourse analysts to do fine-grained analysis of naturally occurring data in real-life contexts. Given the critique of the strong view of not going outside the text, combining CA with other social research methodologies, such as ethnography, may help to counter these criticisms (Flowerdew 2012).

19. Systemic Functional Linguistics (SFL) [Important for True False Section]

An approach to grammar and discourse that has a **three-dimensional model of context**:

Field of discourse, i.e. the subject matter of the text.

Tenor of discourse, i.e. the relations between the participants and their attitudes (as presented in the discourse).

Mode of discourse -the channel, i.e. speech or writing and rhetorical role (i.e. didactic, persuasive, aggressive, etc.) (Bloor and Bloor, p. 154). These three dimensions work together to constitute different varieties of language, i.e., registers (Halliday, McIntosh and Stevens 1964).

Systemic Functional Linguistics enables critical discourse analysts to identify form-function links and thereby to relate language form to context (Fairclough, 2003). Proponents of **SFL** argue that SFL is still the only school with a robust model to link text and context systematically (Flowerdew, 2018).

20. Multi-Modal Discourse Analysis (MMDA).

This type of analysis involves all semiotic systems, not just language use. MMDA is influenced by the work of Halliday (1978) and was pioneered by Kress and van Leeuwen (1996) (both followers of Halliday and CDS practitioners). **MMDA** focusses “specifically on how different semiotic resources are deployed in the re-contextualization of social practices for ideological purposes”.

21. Define Typification.

Typification is, there are typical forms a genre might take as well as typical content and typical action that the genre performs, all of which we recognize and draw on as we engage with the use of genres.

22. Define Meta-Discourse analysis.

The term **meta-discourse** was first coined by the linguist Zellig Harris (1959) to describe the way in which a writer or speaker tries to guide their audience's perception of their text.

Types of Meta-Discourse analysis:

- ❖ **Interactive meta-discourse resources** further guide the readers how to understand ways of expressing relations between clauses, the stages of the text, information that is in other parts of the text, information that has been drawn from other texts and ways of elaborating on meanings in the text.
- ❖ **Interactional meta-discourse resources** further include the ways in which writers express their stance towards what they are saying as well as how they explicitly engage with or address their readers in their texts.

23. Difference between Stance and Engagement.

Stance is the ways in which writers present themselves and convey their judgements, opinions and commitments to their own and other people's work. In doing this, a writer may either 'intrude to stamp their personal authority onto their arguments, or step back and disguise their involvement'.

Engagement is the strategy writers use to acknowledge and recognize the presence of their readers, 'pulling them along with their argument, focusing their attention, acknowledging their uncertainties, including them as discourse participants and guiding them to interpretations' (Hyland 2005: 176).

24. Define Genre-Based-Teaching.

Genre-based teaching can help students gain access to texts and discourses which will, hopefully, help them participate more successfully in second language **spoken and written interactions**. One thing should be kept in mind in **genre-based teaching** that it may limit student-expression if it is done through using model texts and a focus on audience

expectations. Teachers equally need to think about how they can help students bring their own individual voices into their use of particular genres.

25. Write the tools of Communication.

No matter language is a tool of communication but people also uses different modes such as:

- ❖ Images Communication
- ❖ Gesture Communication
- ❖ Gaze Communication
- ❖ Posture Communication

26. Define Corpus.

The word "corpus", derived from the Latin word meaning "body", may be used to refer to any text in written or spoken form. In modern Linguistics, this term is used to refer to large collections of texts which represent a sample of a particular variety or use of language(s) that are presented in machine readable form.

27. Different Kinds of Corpora.

There are many different kinds of corpora

- ❖ According to purpose: General-purpose corpora
- ❖ According to text selection procedure
- ❖ According to Medium
- ❖ Written corpora: only written texts
- ❖ According to number of languages/dialects represented
- ❖ Mixed corpora: both written and spoken material

26. Considerations while deciding a sampling policy:

There are three considerations that we must attend to in deciding a sampling policy:

1. The orientation to the language or variety to be sampled.
2. The criteria on which we will choose samples.
3. The nature and dimensions of the samples.

27. Define Positive discourse analysis.

PDA focuses on “positive” orientations to discourse analysis. Both “deconstructive **and** constructive activity” are required to produce a healthy and socially useful CDA (Martin, 2012: 282). It aims to invest intellectual resources in setting an agenda of social change and future aims through discourse analysis.

The purview of CDA could include the documentation of: (For MCQs)

1. minority discourses, diasporic voices, texts, and statements that are ‘written out’ and over by dominant institutions.
2. emergent discourses of hybrid identity generated by learners [or other marginal groups] counter to dominant pedagogic [and other] discourses;
3. idiosyncratic local uptakes, where human subjects take centrally broadcast or dominant texts and discourses and reinterpret, recycle and revoice them in particular ways that serve their local political interests; and this may involve “translating” outside discourses into locally amenable terms.

28. Fairclough’s criticism.

Fairclough’s criticism revolves around two significant points.

- ❖ First, he argues that Pragmatics does not take into account the conditions and power imbalances of the social world, and instead postulates an ideal, smooth communicative situation.

- ❖ Second, he finds problematic the theorization of the participants of communicative events, which “understates the extent to which people are caught up in, constrained by, and indeed derive their individual identities from social conventions”.

The limited scope has led Fairclough to suggest that Pragmatics “often appears to describe discourse as it might be in a better world, rather than discourse as it is” .

29. Define Linguistic competence and Performance.

- ❖ Linguistic competence is the system of linguistic knowledge possessed by native speakers of a language. Linguistic competence is innate. Linguistic competence underlies linguistic performance. A speaker still has his linguistic competence even he does not speak.
- ❖ Linguistic performance is the way the language system is used in communication.

30. Write Three-part model of context.

Malinowski and Firth, also proposed a three-part model of context. For him, context consists of:

- ❖ Field: The social action that is taking place.
- ❖ Tenor: The participants, their roles and relationships.
- ❖ Mode: The symbolic or rhetorical channel and the role which language plays in the situation.

31. Three kinds of Acts (Austin).

Locutionary Act Literal meanings of the actual words

Illocutionary Act Speaker's intention in uttering the words

Perlocutionary Act The effect of an utterance on the thoughts or actions of the other

person. e.g. 'Bus Driver: This bus won't move until you boys move in out of the doorway'
(taken from Paltridge, 2006)

32. Maxim of Quantity.

Make your contribution as informative as is required for the current purposes of the exchange. Do not make the contribution more informative than is required.

33. Kinds of Conversational Analysis.

Two kinds of conversational implicature: *conventional* and *particularized conversational implicatures*.

- ❖ **With conventional implicatures**, no particular context is required in order to derive the implicature. The use of ‘anyway’ conventionally implicates a return to the original topic of a conversation (Lo Castro 2003). The use of ‘but’ and ‘on the other hand’ to express contrast, ‘even’ to suggest something is contrary to expectation and ‘yet’ to suggest something will be different at a later time, are further examples of conventional implicatures.
- ❖ **Particularized conversational implicatures**, however, are derived from a particular context, rather than from the use of the words alone. These result from the maxim of relation. That is, the speaker assumes the hearer will search for the relevance of what is said and derive an intended meaning. For example:

A: You're out of coffee.

B: Don't worry there's a shop on the corner.

A derives from B's answer that they will be able to buy coffee from the shop on the corner.

Most implicatures, in fact, are particularized conversational implicatures.

34. Define Politeness and Face.

Politeness generally refers to the ideas like being tactful, modest and nice to other people. In pragmatics, politeness can be defined as ‘showing awareness and consideration of another person's face’. (Yule, 2010)

Face – Public self image – emotional and social sense of self that everyone expects everyone else to recognise. Three Maxims of Politeness (Lakoff, 1973)

35. Strategies/tools for Text Analysis:

Halliday and Webster (2014) illustrate the analysis of texts using:

- ❖ Analysis of the **linguistic elements** that express experience of the world and of our own consciousness. They used Process, and Participant and Circumstances analysis which are the main components of the transitivity system enable us to organize, represent and understand our perceptions of the world. They form what is known as the **ideational component**.
- ❖ Analysis of the **linguistic elements** that express roles, attitudes, demands and social & personal relations including mood, modality, appraisal, politeness. This interpersonal component is seen as ‘acting out social relationships’.
- ❖ Analysis of the **linguistic elements** that serve to construct cohesive and coherent chunks of language in use including means of reference, rhetorical structure theory and thematic structure. This is known as the textual component.

36. SFL tools For Text Analysis include:

- ❖ Statistical comparison techniques
- ❖ Comparisons of lexical density and frequency
- ❖ Rhetorical Structure Theory
- ❖ Corpus linguistics

Transitivity in SLF (Important for True False Section)

A widely used tool of analysis in CDA is the SFL transitivity system, which should not be confused with the simpler transitive/intransitive dichotomy in traditional grammar. In SFL transitivity analysis, three categories can be identified: *processes*, *participants* and (optionally) *circumstances*. As far as CDA is concerned, when realised in discourse, this is a focus of analysis in the critical evaluation of **content** and **ideology**. Consider the following example (1) from a recent newspaper article, which is a reply to a rhetorical question given by the journalist: ‘But can we trust Mr. Cameron’s promises?’ The Process in the clause has been written in red.

(1) His government (Actor) has overseen dramatic increases in most forms of taxation. This clause clearly presents Cameron’s government as allowing increases in taxation, but does not emphasise on government’s total responsibility for it.

37. Define Image Schema.

The path image schema, for instance, has its basis in our experience of (forward) motion, and encompasses a starting location and a destination, the path between these two points

38. Three types of Proof in CDA:

- ❖ **Logos** - proof by the arguments presented in the speech.
- ❖ **Ethos** - proof through the credibility of the character of the speaker
- ❖ **Pathos** - proof by the emotional disposition of the audience.

39. How Kress define Design?

Kress used a term “design” which focused on using past agendas and products as resources in setting future aims and in assembling means to implement them. **Design** needs to be based on studies of “how people get together and make room for themselves in the word in ways that redistribute power without necessarily struggling against it”.

40. Pragmatic Arguments:

Arguments based on good or bad consequences of actions are indispensable within everyday argumentation. Later on, these were called **Pragmatic Arguments**

41. Criteria on which the texts that form the corpus will be selected.

Common criteria include:

1. **the mode of the text**; whether the language originates in speech or writing, or perhaps nowadays in electronic mode;
2. **the type of text**; for example, if written, whether a book, a journal, a notice or a letter;
3. **the domain of the text**; for example, whether academic or popular;
4. **the language or languages** or language varieties of the corpus;
5. **the location of the texts**; for example (the English of) UK or Australia;
6. **the date of the texts**

42. Define Presupposition.

Presupposition is primarily a figure-ground distinction. The presupposed knowledge surfaces in the text as ‘setting the background’, with the foregrounded knowledge being presented as new or significant. Presuppositions thus may be more difficult (but not impossible) to refute, because this would require a shift of focus – bringing the backgrounded material to the foreground.

43. Objections to SFL in Critical Discourse Analysis

- ❖ Meriel Bloor and Thomas Bloor have discussed Van Dijk’s (2008) objection to SFL “as a framework for the study of discourse”, in part because it involves “too much linguistic (lexico-syntactic) sentence grammar” and “too much esoteric vocabulary”.
- ❖ Van Dijk (2008) sees some limitations in the **SFL theory of context**.
- ❖ Van Dijk is concerned about what he sees as the ‘**anti-mentalist**’ position of SFL seemingly based on his reading of Halliday 1978. Van Dijk takes a **socio-cognitive** approach to CDA and he is interested in individual ‘mental models’.

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